

Terms overview

Voice | Belonging | Borders

6l26en - Sommer 2026

Use this sheet when you prepare for the oral exam. Try to connect the terms to specific texts, scenes, quotations, or examples.

Voice

Core terms

Term	Meaning / how to use it
voice	The way a person, narrator, speaker, or text expresses ideas, feelings, and identity.
personal voice	A voice that feels individual, honest, or strongly connected to someone's own experience.
narrative voice	The voice telling a story. Ask: who speaks, what do they know, and how do they see the world?
speaker	The "I" or voice in a poem, speech, or text. Not always the same as the author.
point of view	The perspective from which a story or argument is presented.
tone	The attitude or mood of the voice, e.g. serious, angry, ironic, hopeful, bitter, humorous.
register	The level of language: formal, informal, academic, emotional, everyday, slang etc.
identity	How a person sees themselves, and how they are seen by others.
expression	The act of showing thoughts, feelings, beliefs, or personality through language or art.
silence	When someone cannot, will not, or is not allowed to speak.
being heard	When a voice is recognised, respected, or taken seriously.
marginalised voices	Voices from people or groups who are often ignored or excluded.
empowerment	Gaining confidence, strength, or the right to speak and act.
freedom of speech	The right to express opinions without censorship or punishment.
rhetoric	The art of using language to persuade or affect an audience.
ethos	Appeal to credibility, authority, or trust.
pathos	Appeal to emotions.
logos	Appeal to reason, evidence, and logic.
repetition	Repeating words or phrases for emphasis.
anaphora	Repetition at the beginning of successive clauses or sentences.
rule of three	Three words, phrases, or examples used together for effect.
metaphor	A figurative comparison where one thing is described as another.

Connect to theme by asking:

- Who has a voice in this text, and who does not?
- What kind of voice is created: confident, uncertain, angry, personal, official, poetic?
- How does the language reveal the speaker's identity or values?
- Is the text about speaking up, being silenced, or being listened to?
- How does the voice affect the reader or audience?

Sentence starters

- The text presents voice as...
- The narrator's/speaker's voice seems...
- Through the use of ..., the speaker creates a sense of...
- The text gives voice to...
- The silence of ... is important because...

Belonging

Core terms

Term	Meaning / how to use it
belonging	Feeling accepted, connected, and at home in a place, group, relationship, or identity.
home	A physical place, but also a feeling of safety, memory, identity, and connection.
community	A group of people connected by place, culture, values, experience, or relationships.
family	Biological or chosen relationships that can create belonging, conflict, or responsibility.
identity	A person's sense of who they are, shaped by memory, place, language, relationships, and society.
loneliness	Feeling isolated, unseen, or disconnected from others.
alienation	A stronger form of not belonging; feeling like an outsider or stranger.
exclusion	Being kept outside a group, place, or social world.
inclusion	Being accepted into a group or community.
social class	A person's position in society based on money, status, education, or background.
prejudice	Judging someone before knowing them, often based on class, race, gender, culture, or appearance.
recognition	Being seen and accepted by others as who you are.
safety	The feeling that one is protected physically, socially, or emotionally.
privacy	Having a personal space where one can be oneself.
memory	Past experiences that shape identity and belonging.
nostalgia	A longing for the past, often connected to memory and loss.
escapism	Escaping from reality into fantasy, memory, entertainment, or another world.
second chance	The possibility of beginning again or creating a new form of life or belonging.
dialect	A variety of language connected to a place, region, or social group.
setting	The time and place of a text; often important for creating belonging or alienation.

Connect to theme by asking:

- Where does the character feel at home, and where do they feel out of place?
- What creates belonging: family, place, love, memory, language, class, or choice?
- Is belonging presented as something you find, choose, or build?
- How does the setting influence the character's sense of belonging?
- What causes loneliness or exclusion in the text?

Sentence starters

- The text explores belonging through...
- The character feels excluded because...
- Home is presented not only as a place, but as...
- The setting creates a feeling of...
- The text suggests that belonging depends on...

Borders

Core terms

Term	Meaning / how to use it
border	A line, limit, or division between places, people, identities, or ideas.
boundary	A limit that can be physical, social, emotional, moral, or psychological.
national border	A border between countries.
border crossing	Moving across a border; can be literal or symbolic.
migration	Moving from one country or place to another, often for work, safety, family, or opportunity.
exile	Being forced to live away from one's home or country.
refugee	A person forced to leave their country because of war, persecution, or danger.
immigrant	A person who moves to another country to live there.
culture	The values, traditions, language, habits, and art of a group of people.
cultural identity	A person's sense of belonging to one or more cultures.
hybridity	A mixed identity shaped by more than one culture, place, or language.
fluid identity	An identity that changes depending on place, context, or how others see you.
othering	Treating someone as different, foreign, or less normal than "us".
assimilation	Adapting to fit into a new dominant culture, sometimes by losing parts of one's old identity.
integration	Becoming part of a new society while still keeping important parts of one's own identity.
liminality	Being in-between two places, identities, stages of life, or social roles.
threshold	A doorway or point of transition between one state and another.
wall	A physical or symbolic structure that separates and protects, but can also isolate.
division	Separation between people, groups, or ideas.
connection	What links people across borders or differences.
transgression	Breaking or crossing a rule, limit, or boundary.

Connect to theme by asking:

- What kind of border is central: national, cultural, personal, social, psychological, or symbolic?
- Who creates the border, and why?
- Who wants to cross the border, and what are the consequences?
- Does the border protect, divide, exclude, or connect people?

Sentence starters

- The border in the text can be understood as...
- The wall/boundary both separates and...
- The character crosses a border when...

General analytical terms

Useful across all three units.

Term	Meaning / how to use it
theme	A central idea or issue in a text.
message	What the text seems to suggest about a theme.
characterisation	How a character is presented through actions, speech, thoughts, appearance, and relationships.
setting	The time and place of a story, including the social, cultural, and physical environment.
conflict	A struggle between people, values, desires, places, or identities.
imagery	The use of vivid, descriptive language that appeals to the senses or creates a mental picture.
symbol	Something concrete that represents a larger idea.
contrast	A difference used to highlight an idea, e.g. inside/outside, silence/voice, home/away.
motif	A repeated image, idea, object, or situation.
perspective	The angle from which events or ideas are seen.
context	The social, historical, cultural, or political background of a text.
rhetorical devices	Language techniques used to affect or persuade the audience, e.g. repetition, rhetorical questions, metaphors, contrasts, anaphora, or the rule of three.
rhetorical pentagram	A model for analysing non-fiction texts by looking at sender, receiver/audience, topic, language, and situation/context.
quotation	A short piece of evidence from the text used to support your point.